



EA Profession: What's Changing and What's Not?

AOGEA Michigan Chapter Meeting

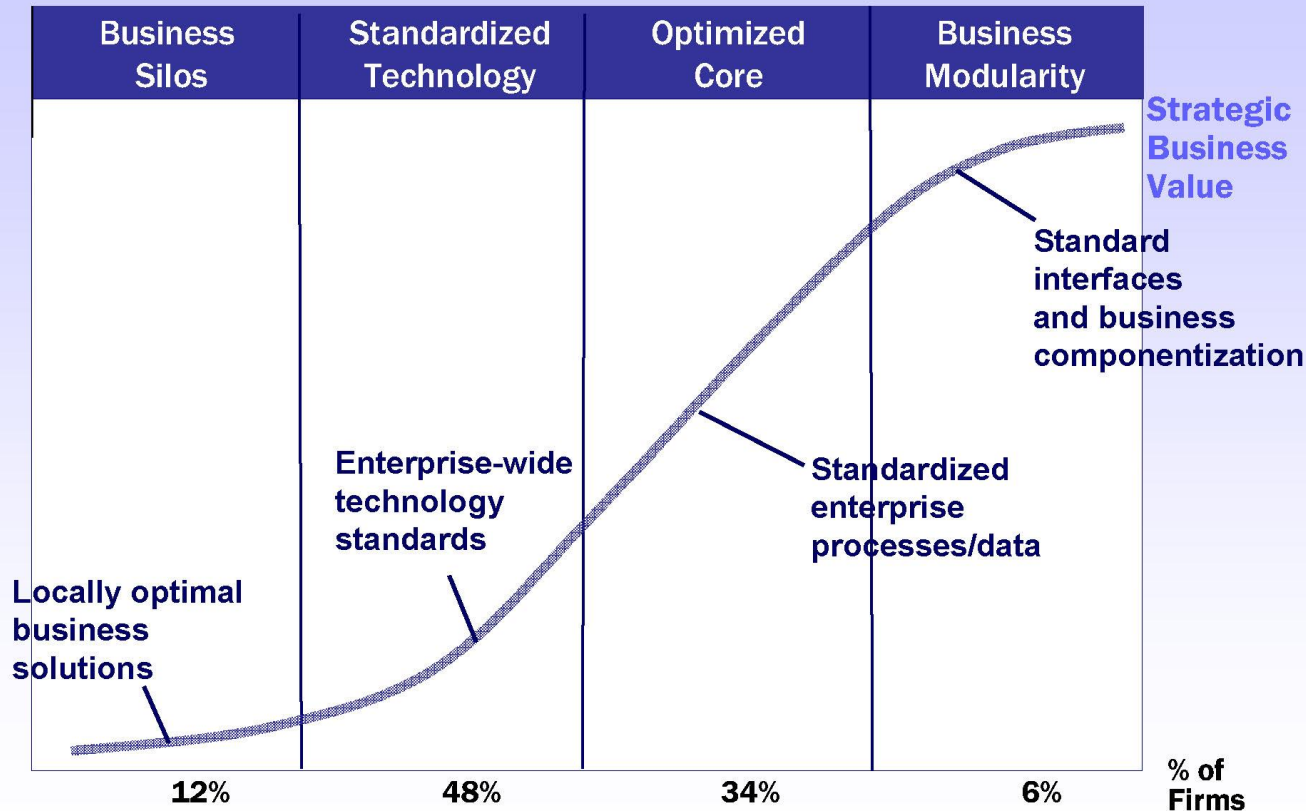
Tim Westbrook
Managing Director

September 24, 2009

Putting Things in Perspective

- **Business change / transformation / innovation**
 - Intentional and unintentional
 - Many environmental factors (gov/reg, eco, tech, demo, geo, political, etc.)
- **Leveraging new technology capabilities**
 - Virtualization , Proliferation of devices, Tech-tonics, Everything is Recorded Digitally, Predictive Modeling Explodes, “Zero Downtime”, Self-service “Everything”, 7x24 work availability, Ubiquitous “real-time” sensors, ...
- **Unwieldy / unmanageable, overly complex (and changing) IT environment is an obstacle to rapid change**
 - Lack of standards, lack of reuse and reusability, p2p interfacing, old/obsolete technologies

Architecture Maturity Stages Yield Increasing Value from IT



Source: *Enterprise Architecture as Strategy: Creating a Foundation for Business Execution*, J. Ross, P. Weill, D. Robertson, HBS Press, June 2006.

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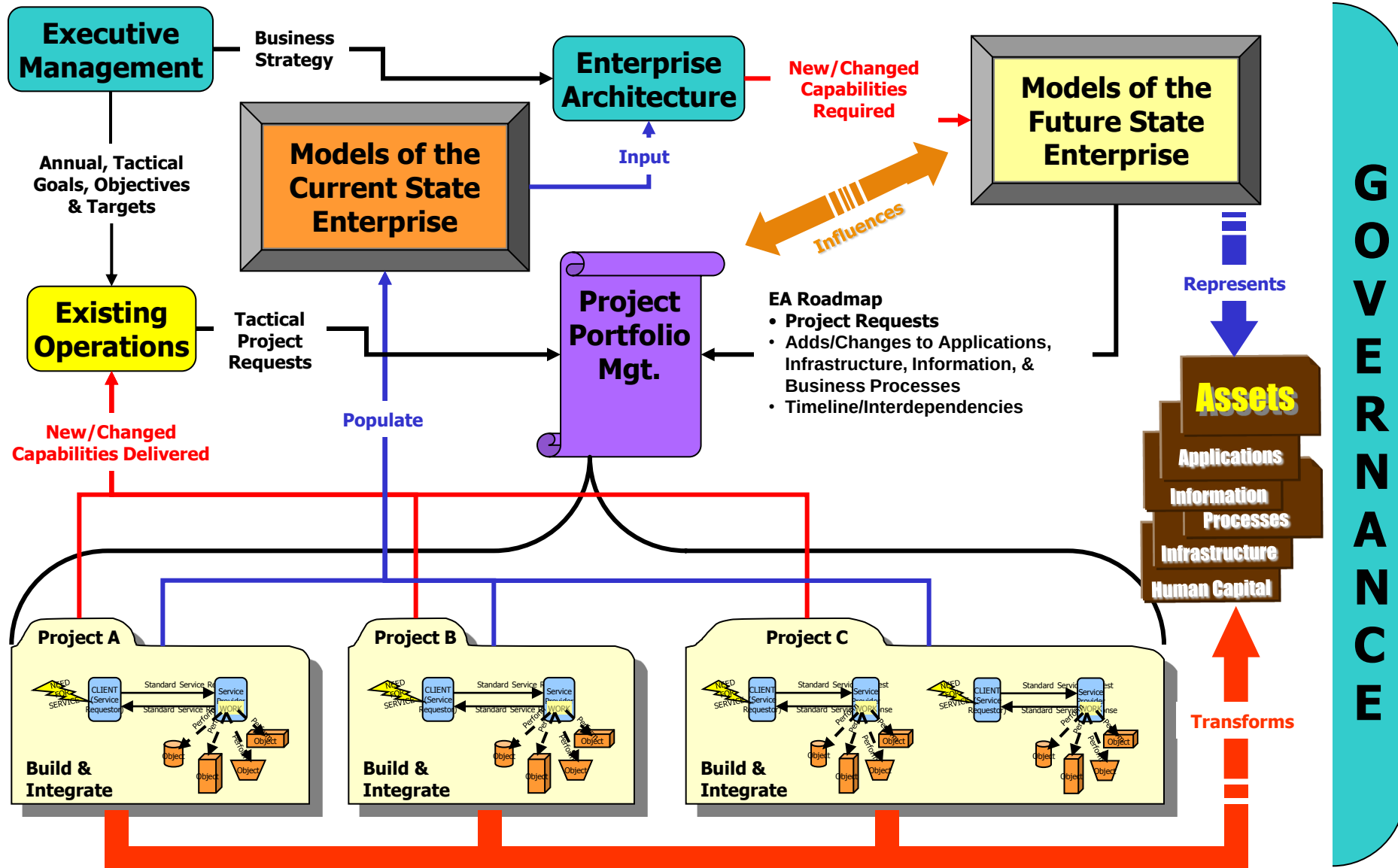
- **MIT Sloan CISR:** the organizing logic for business processes and IT infrastructure reflecting the integration and standardization requirements of the firm's operating model.
- **IFEAD:** complete expression of the enterprise; a master plan which “acts as a collaboration force” between aspects of business planning such as goals, visions, strategies and governance principles; aspects of business operations such as business terms, organization structures, processes and data; aspects of automation such as information systems and databases; and the enabling technological infrastructure of the business such as computers, operating systems and networks.
- **Wiktionary (*source unknown*):** the disposition and interrelationship of all the management, information and computing systems within an organization.
- **IEAI:** The analysis and documentation of an enterprise in its current and future states from an integrated strategy, business, and technology perspective.
- **Coherency Management¹:** the inherent design and management approach essential for organizational coherence leading to alignment, agility and assurance
- **TOGAF: (*Architecture*)** The structure of components, their interrelationships, and the principles and guidelines governing their design and evolution over time.

¹Book written by Gary Doucet, John Gotze, Pallab Saha and Scott Bernard. EAdirections contributed a chapter.

- **Enterprise Architecture (EA)** is a strategic management discipline that creates a single, holistic view of the business processes, systems, information and technology of the enterprise designed and optimized to create shareholder value by achieving both the long-term business strategy as well as current business objectives.
- **Intent of EA process:** Identify the impact of enterprise strategies and influence lower-level tactical, operational, and project decisions and activities to be more aligned with enterprise strategies.

The primary design goal for enterprise architecture must be to enable efficient change in business capabilities through the *services* that enable them!

EA becomes the driver of EPfM

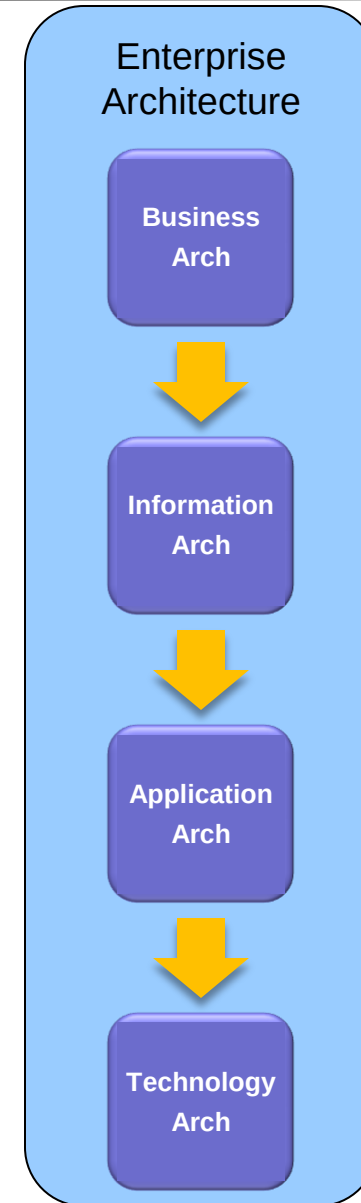


“Are You Architecting the Enterprise?”
Or
“Are You Architecting IT?”

- **MOST EA efforts are driven by and staffed by IT divisions/personnel**
- **How does an IT centric view and application of EA drive Business Innovation and Transformation?**
- **Is enterprise business architecture the domain of IT?**
- **If not, then who creates EBA?**
- **What about business architecture at the sub-enterprise level?**
 - Same questions
- **Is EBA part of EA? Or is EA part of EBA?**

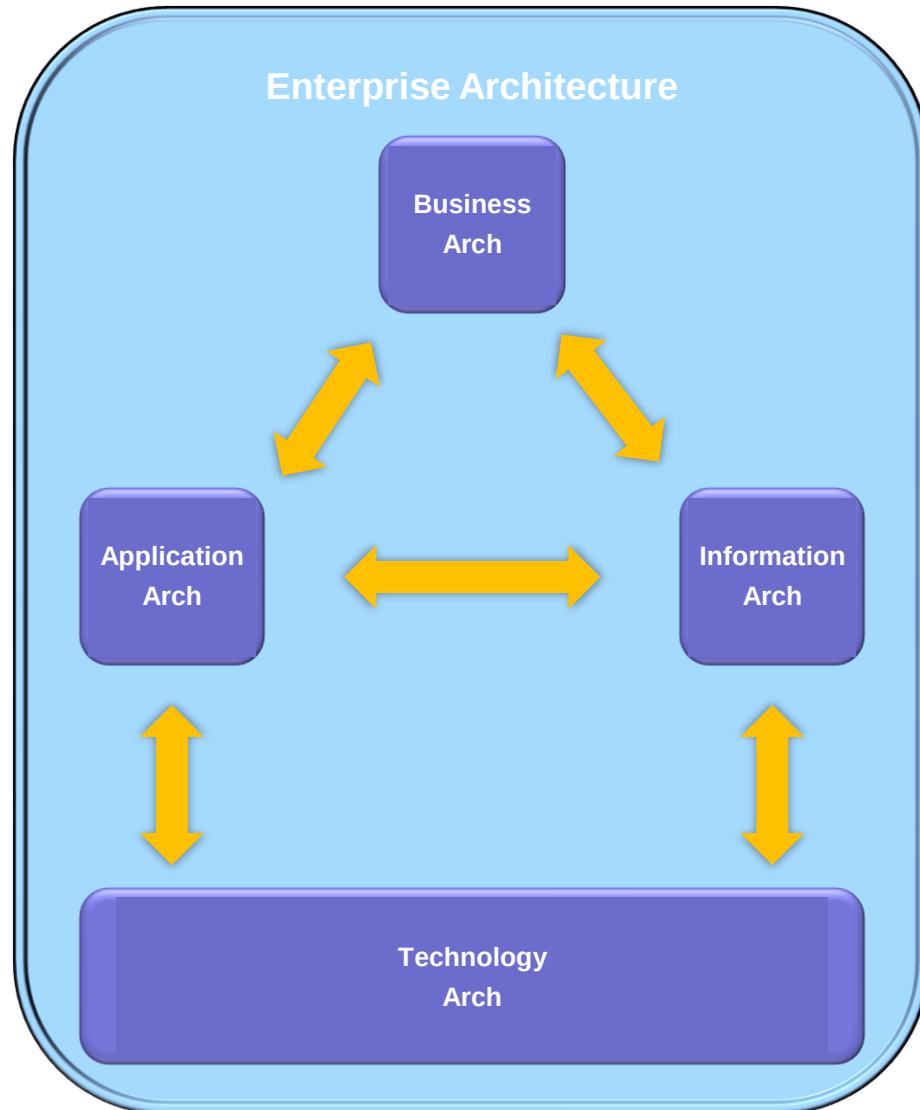
- Impressions:

- Top down
- Business Driven
- Process before Info
- Application before Technology (Infrastructure)
 - Contrary to infrastructure standardization, by the way
- In truth, BA doesn't deliver much value, if any, due to the ownership of EA by the IT organization
 - BA is (maybe) some HL process models, restated strategies
 - IA is treated as Data Arch from the IT perspective
 - Information value is minimal due to the lack of business perspective and ownership
- Typically the value comes from standardization of the Technology and Application Architecture (Maturity Stage 2)
- Allows for a sound platform upon which to architect and build the enterprise
- A NECESSARY STEP



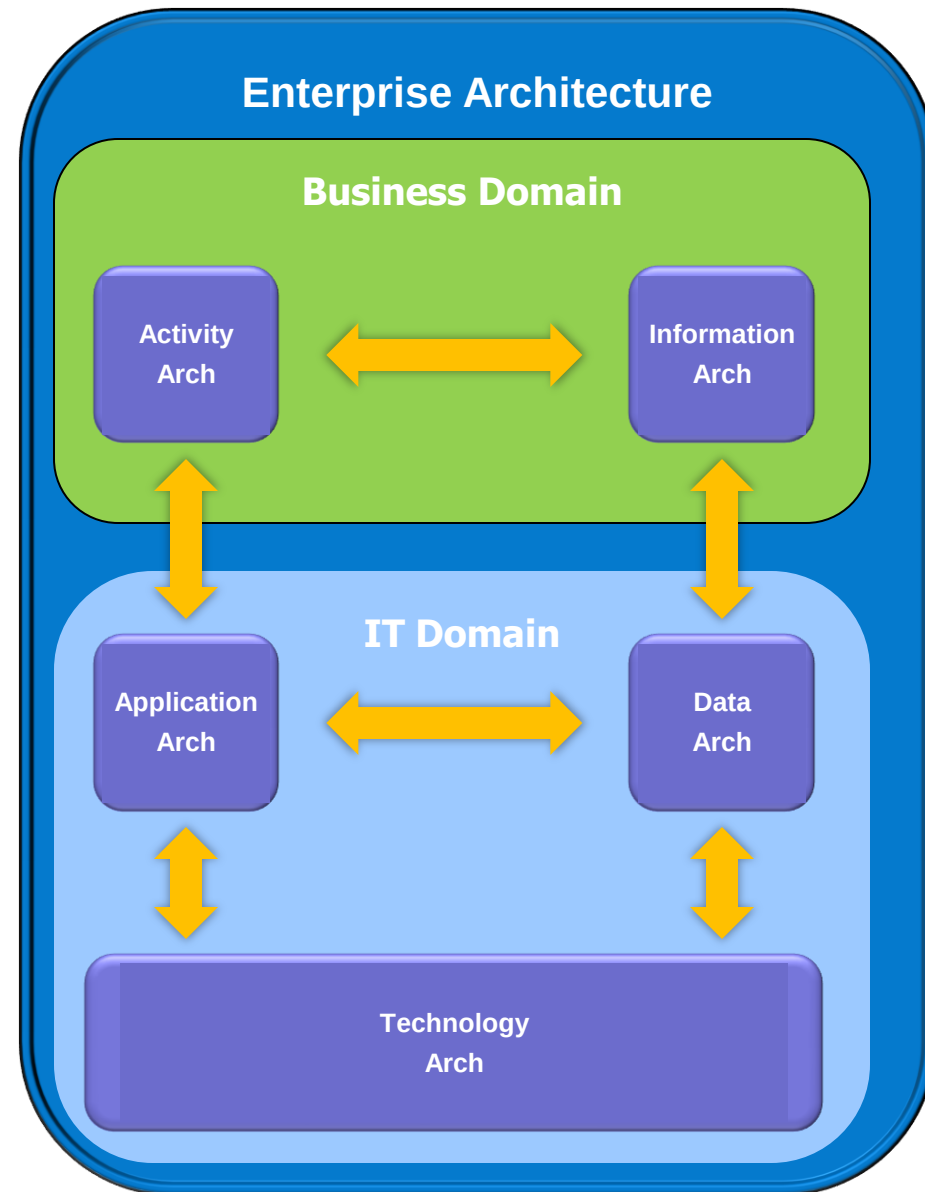
- **Impressions:**

- Business Driven
- More depth to BA and IA
 - Better Row 1/Row 2 models
 - Capabilities Analysis
- Still owned by IT organization
- IA still more data-focused
- Value derived from optimization of the Application portfolio and/or data standardization (Maturity Stage 3); which leads to an environment in which standard interfaces and business modularity is enabled (Maturity Stage 4)
- Provides for a more adaptable IT foundation and quicker time to market
- SOA partially possible here (enabled from the IT side)



- **Impressions:**

- Work Activities and Information are the domain of the business
 - Probably a Human Resources domain too
- App, Data and Technology are the domain of IT
- Business Activities drive the Application Architecture
- Business Information drives the Data Architecture
- Technology Architecture directly enables data and applications (not work activity and information)
- Is there more beyond Maturity Stage 4?
- Is this where true Business Innovation and Transformation are possible?



EA as a Profession

- **Common Definition**
- **Consistent training and curriculum**
 - University programs in the specialty
- **Governed accreditation and certification**
 - Including national/state licensing
- **Common (Foundation) skills / Specialty Skills**
- **Commonly accepted roles and responsibilities**
- **Recognized career paths**
- **Other traits**
 - Common tools and methods
 - Professional associations
 - Professional code of ethics

- **Bad News**

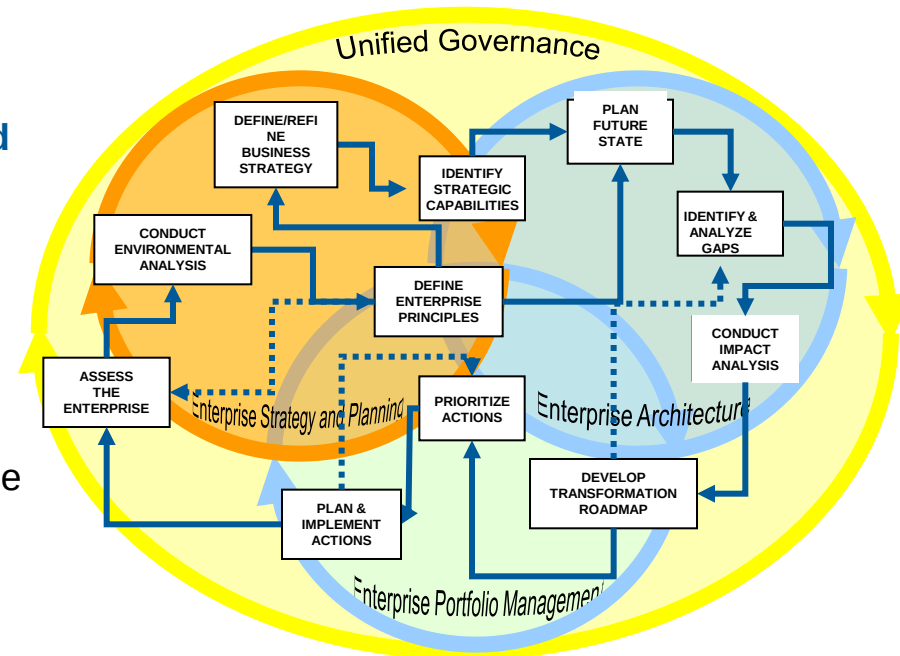
- Legally, we may not be able to call ourselves professional “architects” (TX, for instance)
- Is EA a business discipline or an IT discipline?
- Competing/inconsistent definitions, certifications

- **Good News**

- More focus on business architecture is causing a recognition of the conflict between EA and ITA
- Groups trying to drive the formalization of EA as a profession
- EA and other architects are not suffering from the current recession as much as other IT disciplines and the job market in general
- Still lots of room left to mature as an IT discipline while EBA/EIA approaches, benefits, skills, models, etc. mature
- EA Courses are being taught in some colleges in North America, Europe, Australia
 - GWU, Bentley University, CMU Heinz College in Australia, Reading University in UK (TOGAF)
 - Others are investigating – UCLA, Penn State

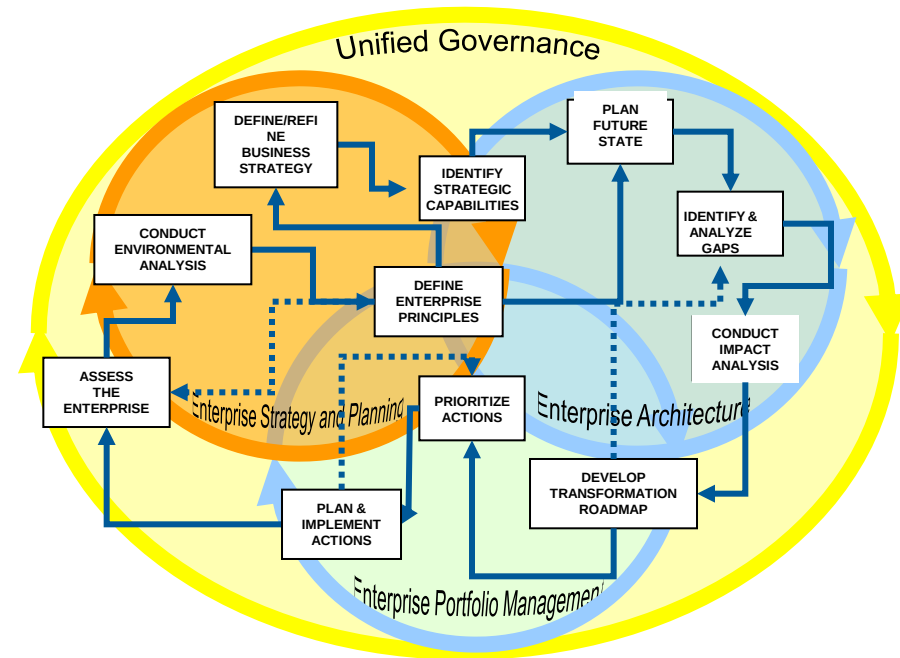
What's Changing in the next 5 Years?

- Org Split into Strategic and Tactical
- More emphasis on business skills
- More emphasis on soft skills
- New frameworks with an industry/functional/business bent
- More consolidation of business analyst and business architecture skills, roles and responsibilities
- Better integration between EA repository, CMDB and Asset Management tools
- Architecture specialties (not EA)
 - Customer facing (both business and technology), Supply Chain, Cloud (Service Provider Integration), Real-time, etc.
- Increased Portfolio Management competencies increase value of EA
- A VERY FEW (but some) EA functions transition into the business – What will they call it?



What's Not Changing in the next 5 Years?

- EA remains an IT discipline for majority of enterprises
- Maintain IT foundation for change
 - Dealing with change and complexity
- Competing / Inconsistent Definitions and Certifications
- No integrated toolset EA, CMDB and Asset Management
- The vast majority will still call it Enterprise Architecture
- The uniqueness of EA (process, benefits, priorities and deliverables) within a given enterprise
- Continued R&D and leveraging of new technology
- Dependence on architects within IT
- Expanding of architects skills and IT specialties continues



- **More consistency in semantics and terminology**
- **EA owns the service portfolio**
 - What services should the enterprise have?
 - Who should provide the service (internal or external SP)?
 - Who should consume the service?
- **Further integration between Service Management (ITIL) and EA processes**
- **Consolidation of certifications**
- **More university courses on EA**
- **More involvement in EBA efforts from those responsible for business strategy/transformation/innovation**
- **More companies move into the Transformation View of EA**

- **Not a Profession Yet**
- **Good things being done by a lot of individuals and groups to promote the evolution of the profession**
- **Clarification of EA vs. ITA needed**
- **Great position for those with a passion for enabling change, focusing on the big picture and looking forward**



George S. Paras



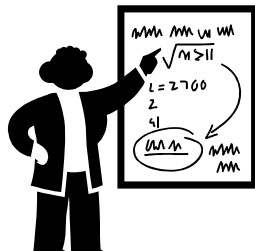
Larry R. DeBoever



Tim Westbrook

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- **Founded by Larry R. DeBoever, George S. Paras, Tim Westbrook**
 - 50+ years of combined leadership in Enterprise Architecture
 - Launched the Enterprise Architecture Strategies (EAS) service at the META Group in 1996
 - Launched the first EAC with in 1997; continuously chaired
 - Editor-in-Chief of Architecture & Governance Magazine
 - Associate Editors of the Journal of Enterprise Architecture
 - Founding members of SIM Enterprise Architecture Working Group (SIMEAWG)
 - Named one of the 5 'Pioneers' of EA by SIM
 - **Our Mission - Improve the effectiveness of enterprise architecture (EA) teams by creating deep, mentoring relationships driven by independent research.**

Thought Leaders. Mentors. Deep Relationships.



Ongoing Mentoring of the EA Team

- Create an EA charter, communication plan and set priorities
- Gain support among the Business Units & IT
- Identify 'quick wins' and short-term goals
- Integrate EA with other IT processes
- Select a Framework and Repository when appropriate



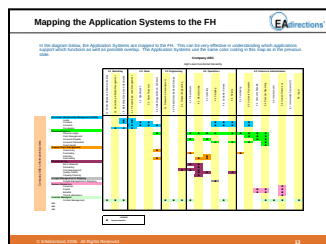
Assessing EA Activities & Review Deliverables

- Provide honest feedback and prescriptive advice
- Critique documents to improve effectiveness especially for C-level
- Guide development of new artifacts
- Ongoing review of emerging issues and



Building the Extended EA Team

- Establish EA team roles and responsibilities
- Establish virtual groups working collaboratively with EA
- Building a culture of collaboration and effectiveness focused on 'enterprise outcomes'



Providing 'Jump Start' Materials & Other Research

- Provide 'quick & dirty' enterprise-wide templates for Business, Information, Solutions & Technical Architectures
- Templates for demonstrating Business/IT alignment
- Tools for 'Business Fit' vs. Technical Fit', etc.
- Perform on-going research



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